

The Nature of God: The Uncontainable Spirit Who Walks with Us

A working study in the Noble Mind Study method — four sections, NASB-anchored, Scripture interpreting Scripture. Working draft. This combines the inductive core on God as Spirit who fills all in all with the very first recorded example of His personal nearness: walking and talking with Adam and Eve in the Garden. No systematic theology, no philosophical categories, no later creedal language. Scripture alone supplies the description of the One who is both everywhere-present and intimately near.

01 — What the text actually says

Scripture opens the story of God's relationship with humanity in the most personal way possible:

- Genesis 3:8, NASB: "They heard the sound of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God among the trees of the garden."

The Hebrew verb *mithallek* describes ordinary walking; the text presents God as producing audible footsteps at a specific time of day. Adam and Eve know exactly who it is and hide from His presence (*pāneyw* — "His face"). The same Bible that records this scene also declares without qualification that God cannot be contained by any created space:

- John 4:24, NASB: "God is spirit, and those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth."
- Jeremiah 23:23–24, NASB: "'Am I a God who is near,' declares the LORD, 'And not a God far off? Can a man hide himself in hiding places So I do not see him?' declares the LORD. 'Do I not fill the heavens and the earth?' declares the LORD."
- Psalm 139:7–12, NASB: "Where can I go from Your Spirit? Or where can I flee from Your presence? ... Even there Your hand will lead me, And Your right hand will lay hold of me."
- 1 Kings 8:27, NASB: "But will God indeed dwell on the earth? Behold, heaven and the highest heaven cannot contain You..."
- Acts 17:24–28, NASB: "...the God who made the world and all things in it... does not dwell in temples made with hands... for in Him we live and move and exist..."

Yet the same uncontainable God is also the eternal Word who became flesh:

- John 1:14, NASB: "And the Word became flesh, and dwelt among us..."
- Philippians 2:6–8, NASB: "...who, although He existed in the form of God... emptied Himself, taking the form of a bond-servant, and being made in the likeness of men."

The text never softens either reality. It simply places them side by side: the Spirit who fills the heavens and the earth is the same One who walks in a garden, speaks face to face, and later tabernacles among us in human flesh.

02 — The pattern Scripture gives

From the first chapters of Genesis onward, the Bible shows one consistent pattern: the God who is Spirit and fills all in all repeatedly chooses localized, personal, tangible presence with His creatures.

- Eden (Genesis 3:8): God walks and talks with Adam and Eve as their daily companion.
- Theophanies throughout the Old Testament:
 - Genesis 18:1–8 — “the LORD” appears to Abraham as a man, eats a real meal, and converses face-to-face.
 - Exodus 33:11, NASB — “Thus the LORD used to speak to Moses face to face, just as a man speaks to his friend.”
 - Judges 13:20–22 — the angel of the LORD ascends in the flame; Manoah realizes “we have seen God.”
- New Testament climax: The eternal Son — “in whom all things hold together” (Colossians 1:17) and through whom the Father created all things (John 1:3; Hebrews 1:2) — becomes flesh and walks among us (John 1:14). He eats, sleeps, weeps, touches, and is touched, all while remaining “the image of the invisible God” (Colossians 1:15).

Supporting declarations reinforce the same dual reality across both Testaments:

- Isaiah 66:1, NASB: “Heaven is My throne and the earth is My footstool...”
- Ephesians 4:6, NASB: “...one God and Father of all who is over all and through all and in all.”
- Deuteronomy 6:4 remains the unchanging foundation: one God, now revealed in the unified action of Father, Son, and Holy Spirit (Matthew 28:19; 1 Corinthians 8:6).

The pattern never changes: the uncontainable Spirit is never distant or impersonal. He draws near, speaks, walks beside, and ultimately dwells with us.

03 — What the text does not do

- It does not explain how the Spirit who fills the heavens and the earth can produce audible footsteps in a garden, eat a meal with Abraham, speak face to face with Moses, or take on human flesh in the incarnation. It simply reports the events.
- It does not treat these appearances as illusions, temporary “modes,” or lesser versions of God. The text says “the LORD God” was walking, eating, speaking.
- It does not reduce God to either an “entity in one place” or an impersonal force. Both instincts are foreign to Scripture.
- It does not resolve the tension between infinite Spirit and finite nearness for our comprehension. Instead, it repeatedly reminds us that God’s nature is higher than our finite minds: Isaiah 55:8–9, NASB: “‘For My thoughts are not your thoughts, Nor are your ways My ways,’ declares the LORD. ‘For as the heavens are higher than the earth, So are My ways higher than your ways And My thoughts than your thoughts.’” Romans 11:33–34, NASB: “Oh, the depth of the riches both of the wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable are His judgments and unfathomable His ways!” Job 11:7–9, NASB:

“Can you discover the depths of God? ... They are high as the heavens... Deeper than Sheol... broader than the sea.”

The text never apologizes for this incomprehensibility. It presents it as the proper posture of the creature before the Creator.

04 — Answer

God is the uncontainable Spirit who fills the heavens and the earth — present everywhere at once — and He is the same personal God who walked in the garden with Adam and Eve, spoke face to face with Moses, ate with Abraham, and ultimately became flesh and dwelt among us in the Son. Scripture holds both realities without qualification or diagram. The God who cannot be contained by the highest heaven is the God who produces real footsteps in the cool of the day and tabernacles among us. Your observation is exactly right: we mortals instinctively picture God as “an entity in one place” because that is how we experience existence. The Bible gently corrects that picture from the very first chapters onward. The study stops here because that is where Scripture stops. It shows us who God is. It does not give us the mechanics. Deuteronomy 29:29, NASB still governs: “The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things revealed belong to us...” This is the starting point the text itself supplies. It humbles us, comforts us, and invites us to worship “in spirit and truth” (John 4:24) — the very God who is higher than the heavens and closer than our next breath.